



Workshop 3: Canva for Employability & CV Creation

Using Canva as a simple, hands-on tool to build a real CV and practise presenting yourself.

10 participants

Young adults, 18+

Morocco & Senegal

Canva + CV + interview

This session was about Canva, but really about employability: using a simple tool to present yourself well on paper. We had the same group of ten young adults from Morocco and Senegal who had been with us in the previous sessions. As we had seen all the way through the programme, most of them had little experience with computers and digital platforms beyond their phones and social media. So we kept the focus on the most useful, most accessible parts of Canva and went for practical results rather than fancy design.

GETTING STARTED WITH CANVA

We opened with a short energizer, "Human Logo", where everyone introduced themselves and invented a small body movement to stand for their own personal "logo". It lightened the mood and made a point at the same time: visual communication and design can be simple, creative and within anyone's reach.

From there we introduced Canva and what people use it for: presentations, posters, social media content and, the part we cared about, CVs. Given the group's starting level, we deliberately stuck to the essentials instead of touring every tool. People learned to move around templates, change text, add images, switch colours and lay out information so it reads clearly and looks good.

Our original plan went further into Canva's design features and AI tools, but it was soon obvious that people needed a fair amount of support just to find their way around. So we adapted on the spot and concentrated on exactly what they would need for the next step: building a professional CV.

BUILDING THE CV

The second half was about putting together each person's CV with Canva templates. Before touching the computers, we talked through what actually makes a CV work. The group discussed why clarity, readability and relevance matter, and the simple reality that employers often spend just a few seconds on each application, so the important things have to jump out fast.

We circled back to the storytelling session, where people had pinned down qualities like being responsible, sociable, hardworking and supportive of others. The push here was to go beyond just listing those words and to show them with real examples from their work and their lives.

Then we walked through the basic structure of a CV: personal details, a short professional profile, work experience, education, languages and skills. We paid special attention to the usual traps too, like cramming in information that adds nothing, writing long paragraphs, or using an unprofessional email address.

After that, everyone worked on their own CV from a template. Trainers and volunteers were on hand the whole time, helping people pick a design that fit, organise their information and write it in a tight, professional way. With the group's limited computer experience this meant a lot of one-to-one support, but people stayed focused and motivated from start to finish.

JOB INTERVIEW ROLE-PLAY

With the CVs done, we moved into a job interview role-play. In pairs, people took turns being the interviewer and the candidate, working from a set of common interview questions.

It gave everyone a chance to practise introducing themselves, talking through their skills and experience, and saying out loud where they want to go professionally. It also tied things together nicely: the CV on the page is one thing, being able to say it with confidence in a room is another, and the two feed each other.

WHAT WE TOOK AWAY

The workshop did what we hoped: it got people comfortable with Canva as a practical tool and sent each of them home with a CV of their own. Because of the group's digital level we trimmed it down to the essentials and aimed at something useful rather than something flashy, and that turned out to be the right call. People could focus on producing a real document while quietly getting more confident with the computer at the same time.

The CV part was especially worthwhile because it built straight on the self-reflection and storytelling from earlier sessions. Together with the interview role-play, it helped people see how to present their skills, experience and goals both on paper and in person, and it left them with concrete tools to lean on in their job search.